SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #88 · THE BIBLE

“I must never question or wrestle with hard passages.”

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Where it often comes from

Being told to “just accept it” when you asked about difficult verses. Fear that questioning the Bible means doubting God. Passages about violence, judgment, or suffering that troubled you. Not having anyone safe to talk to about hard questions. Feeling guilty for being confused.

What Scripture teaches

God’s Word is true and trustworthy, and it also contains hard passages that deserve careful thought. Proverbs says it is the glory of God to conceal a matter and the glory of kings to search it out. Peter admitted that some of Paul’s letters are hard to understand. Jesus opened His disciples’ minds to understand the Scriptures. Paul told Timothy to consider his words, for the Lord would give him insight. Wrestling with hard passages humbly is a way of taking God’s Word seriously.

> *“It is the glory of God to conceal a matter and the glory of kings to search it out”* **(Proverbs 25:2)**.

Also see

> “Open my eyes that I may see wondrous things from Your law” **(Psalm 119:18)**.

> “Consider what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all things” **(2 Timothy 2:7)**.

> “Then He opened their minds to understand the Scriptures” **(Luke 24:45)**.

> “The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things revealed belong to us and to our children forever, so that we may follow all the words of this law” **(Deuteronomy 29:29)**.

Common self-statements

- Questioning the Bible is sinful.
- If a passage troubles me, something is wrong with my faith.
- I should just ignore the hard parts.
- Good Christians understand everything.
- Asking about this will make me lose my faith.
- I’m not allowed to be confused.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must either accept without thought or reject God’s Word.
- **Fear-based thinking:** Avoiding hard passages because questions feel dangerous.
- **Should statements:** “I should understand everything immediately.”
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking Scripture’s own invitation to search things out.

Challenging questions

- What does Proverbs 25:2 say about searching out a matter?
- Did Peter admit that some Scripture is hard to understand?

- What did Jesus do to help His disciples understand?
- Is wrestling with a passage the same as rejecting it?
- What does Deuteronomy 29:29 say about secret things and revealed things?
- Who could help me study this hard passage?
- Can I trust God while I wait for understanding?

Truth summary

> I can question and wrestle with hard passages humbly. God invites me to search out what is hidden and promises to give insight. Some things belong to Him alone, and I can trust Him with them. Wrestling with God's Word is a way of taking it seriously, not rejecting it.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Scripture/Word
- Wisdom
- Truth
- Seeking
- Doubt

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must never question or wrestle with hard passages"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must never question or wrestle with hard passages." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does Proverbs 25:2 say about searching?
- ☐ Did Peter find some Scripture hard?
- ☐ How did Jesus help His disciples understand?
- ☐ Is wrestling the same as rejecting?
- ☐ What belongs to God and what to me?
- ☐ Who can help me study this?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can wrestle with hard passages humbly.
- ☐ God gives insight to those who seek.
- ☐ Some things belong to God alone, and I can trust Him.
- ☐ Wrestling with Scripture is taking it seriously.
- ☐ God can open my eyes to see wonderful things.
- ☐ I can trust God while I wait for understanding.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Proverbs 25:2**
  "It is the glory of God to conceal a matter and the glory of kings to search it out."
- [ ] **Psalm 119:18**
  "Open my eyes that I may see wondrous things from Your law."
- [ ] **2 Timothy 2:7**
  "Consider what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all things."
- [ ] **Luke 24:45**
  "Then He opened their minds to understand the Scriptures."
- [ ] **Deuteronomy 29:29**
  "The secret things belong to the LORD our God, but the things revealed belong to us and to our children forever, so that we may follow all the words of this law."

A verse I found myself: _____

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Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Hard passage journal:** Write one hard passage, my questions, and anything I learn over time.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 119:18 becomes: "Open **Sarah's** eyes that **she** may see wondrous things from Your law."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Choose one hard passage** and read it with a good study Bible or commentary.
- ☐ **Write your questions as a prayer** and ask God for insight.
- ☐ **Ask a pastor or Bible teacher** about the passage that troubles you.
- ☐ **Read Job 38–42,** and notice how God responded to Job's hard questions.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must never question or wrestle with hard passages": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One question I explored
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must never question or wrestle with hard passages.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for Your Word. Help me reject the lie that I must never question or wrestle with hard passages. Open my eyes to see wonderful things in Your Word, give me insight, and help me trust You with what I cannot yet understand. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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